

January 2026 EDA Summary

NYC TLC High-Volume For-Hire Vehicle (HVFHV) Trip Records

1. Dataset Overview

The January 2026 HVFHV dataset contained **20,940,373 trips and 25 columns**. After data-quality checks, **6 completely zero-value records were removed**, resulting in **20,940,367 trips** for analysis.

The dataset contains trips from two major HVFHS providers: **HV0003 and HV0005**. Data-quality checks identified some negative fare/pay values, missing `originating_base_num` values, and unusual distance/duration observations. These records were retained where they could represent valid business observations and flagged for further analysis rather than being removed automatically.

2. Key EDA Findings

Demand Patterns

Trip demand showed a strong time-of-day pattern.

- **6 PM was the busiest hour:** 1,275,537 trips
- **3 AM was the lowest-demand hour:** 313,318 trips
- Evening demand was therefore substantially higher than overnight demand.

Demand also varied considerably across the week. **Saturday recorded the highest demand at approximately 4.05 million trips**, followed by Friday at approximately 3.75 million. Monday recorded the lowest volume at approximately 2.20 million trips.

This indicates that HVFHV demand is strongly concentrated around specific **hours and days**, rather than being evenly distributed throughout the week.

Provider Market Structure

Provider	Trips	Market Share
HV0003	15.25M	72.80%

HV0005	5.69M	27.20%
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HV0003 accounted for nearly three-quarters of January trips.

At the trip level, HV0003 also recorded a higher average fare and driver pay:

Metric	HV0003	HV0005
Average Fare	\$26.13	\$24.36
Average Driver Pay	\$20.11	\$19.09
Average Tips	\$1.12	\$1.27

The results show differences in provider-level trip economics, which were carried forward into the Q1 provider analysis.

Trip Characteristics

January trips were predominantly short-distance and relatively short-duration.

- **71.05%** of trips were below 5 miles.
- The largest distance category was **1–3 miles (40.74%)**.
- **56.96%** of trips lasted between 10–30 minutes.
- The largest duration category was **10–20 minutes (37.62%)**.

This suggests that the January trip network was primarily driven by short urban journeys.

3. Geographic, Airport & Shared-Ride Analysis

Geographic Demand

Trip activity was concentrated in a limited number of pickup locations.

The highest-volume pickup locations included **138, 132, 61, 37, and 76**, with Location 138 recording **364,872 trips**.

Several high-frequency routes were also identified, including **76→76**, **132→265**, **26→26**, and **39→39**. These patterns indicate strong geographic concentration in trip activity.

Airport Trips

Airport-related trips represented **1,552,143 trips**, or **7.41% of January demand**.

Compared with non-airport trips, airport trips had substantially higher trip-level economics:

Metric	Airport	Non-Airport
Average Fare	\$64.13	\$22.57
Average Driver Pay	\$44.37	\$17.87
Average Distance	13.25 mi	3.95 mi
Average Duration	35.03 min	17.45 min

Although airport trips represented a relatively small share of total demand, they formed a significantly higher-value trip segment.

Shared Rides

January recorded **414,004 shared-ride requests**, representing **1.98% of total trips**.

Of these requests, **239,333 resulted in recorded matches**, giving a **57.81% match rate among shared requests**.

Shared rides therefore represented a relatively small part of overall demand but showed measurable adoption and matching activity.

4. Important January Signals

One notable anomaly was observed on **January 25**, when only **322,276 trips** were recorded. This was substantially lower than surrounding days, including January 23 (**804,588**) and January 24 (**880,274**).

The reduction was visible across both providers and hourly demand patterns. The EDA identifies this as a **recorded-demand anomaly requiring further investigation**, but does not establish a specific cause.

Another important finding was that **the highest-demand period was not necessarily the highest-value period**. While 6 PM had the greatest trip volume, average fare and driver pay were highest around **5 AM**. This highlights the importance of analysing both **demand volume and trip economics** rather than relying on volume alone.

5. January Business Takeaway

January 2026 revealed a **high-volume, time-sensitive and geographically concentrated HVFHV market**. Demand was strongest during evenings and weekends, while HV0003 accounted for the majority of trips. Most journeys were short-distance, with airport trips representing a smaller but substantially higher-value segment.

The January analysis established the main themes carried into the broader Q1 analysis:

Demand patterns → Provider performance → Trip economics → Geographic concentration → Airport activity → Shared rides → Monthly anomalies